

Q My budget is Rs. 43,000 and I'm not a hardcore gamer. I have set up the following configuration, please comment.

AOC 2216 SW 22-inch LCD monitor, iBall Benz with 400W SMPS, 1.5 TB Seagate (SATA2), 2 GB (800 MHz) Kingston DDR2 RAM, ASUS P5Q-E 1600 FSB, Quad Core Q9505 2.83 GHz

V. Srikanth

A Since you're not into gaming, I suggest focusing on a good CPU. The Core i7 is much better than the ageing Core 2 Duo. The Core i7 860 is available for Rs. 14,600 and makes a good buy. Invest in an MSI P55 GD65 board for around Rs. 10,500 and 4 GB of DDR3 RAM costing around Rs. 5,000.

I recommend Acer's 2236Vw priced at Rs. 8,700. For the power supply look at a VIP 450 W. This should cost Rs. 2,000. The Seagate 1.5 TB hard drive is available for around Rs. 6,000. You will also need a graphics card. I recommend a GeForce 8400 GS-based card, that should cost Rs. 1,500 or so. Although this would increase your budget by Rs. 3,000, it would be worth it.

Q I'm reviving an old AMD Athlon system and would like to replace / upgrade the following:

- 1) Motherboard
- 2) Processor
- 3) Graphic card (something like a 9400GT/8600GT/equivalent ATI card)
- 4) RAM
- 5) Hard drive

My budget is Rs. 10,000, although I am flexible with it. I require it to play full HD video, play the latest games. Please give a satisfactory configuration, best possible within the budget.

Vishnuram Rajagopalan

A I recommend a combination of AMD Athlon II X2 240 CPU and ASUS M2N68-AM board. The CPU is available for approximately Rs. 3,000, while the motherboard retails for close to Rs. 2,200. Pick up 2 GB DDR2 (667 MHz) RAM which should cost another Rs. 2,000.

For the HDD, I recommend a 7200.11 Seagate 250 GB. Expect to pay another Rs. 2,000 for this. You could also pick up a GeForce 9400 GT from a brand like ZOTAC, Galaxy, MSI or Palit for another Rs. 2,800 or so.

If you want to use this for casual gaming, I recommend a GeForce 9600 GT from ZOTAC, priced at just around the Rs. 5,000 mark.

Q I'm planning to buy a touch-screen mobile phone within Rs. 10,000. I have short-listed Samsung Corby s3653 and Samsung Star. Which one is better? Please suggest a better option.

Prateek

A It all depends on what you want. If you want a QWERTY keypad, you could consider the iMate Kjam. This phone will give you a 2.8-inch touch screen with a full QWERTY keypad. Otherwise, the Corby s3653 should be decent, though you can also look for the LG KP500 (Cookie) for around the same price, which has a touch screen but no QWERTY.

Q I'm planning to buy a gaming rig for around Rs. 40,000. Does it need to be DX 11 capable?

Ron Thomas

A A budget of Rs. 40,000 is not really enough to buy a "gaming rig", but you can get a decent configuration based on a Core 2 Duo E8400 (Rs. 7,800), BioStar I45 motherboard (Rs. 5,500), 2x2 GB DDR2 RAM (4,500) and an ATi Radeon

HD 5770 which supports DX11 and should be priced at Rs. 11,000 or so. Look for brands like Sapphire, Palit, XFX or MSI. For the hard drive, I recommend a 1 TB 7200.12 HDD from Seagate that should be priced at the Rs. 5,000 mark. AOC's 2236Vw should be priced at the Rs. 8,700 mark and will suffice as a good gaming monitor.

It should also compliment the card well. For the power supply, you should consider a Corsair VX 450 priced at the Rs. 3,000 mark. The rest of the peripherals and cabinet are totally your choice, but I would go with a CoolerMaster 690 chassis (Rs. 4,200) and a Logitech keyboard and mouse combo (Rs. 500).

Q I want to buy a 512-MB graphics card. I play only GTA: San Andreas-like games. I also want good performance for HD content and viewing photos. My budget is between Rs. 1,800 and Rs. 2,600.

A I recommend the Galaxy or ZOTAC GeForce 9400 GT graphics card with 256 MB of video RAM. However, this would set you back by around Rs. 2,800.

Q I want to buy an external hard disk of size 500 GB. I want portability with decent speed to store movies, videos, music and photos. Please suggest me some good hard disk models. My relatives suggested either Seagate Free Agent Go or Western Digital.

A For true portability go with a 2.5-inch solution. Seagate's solutions are cheaper, but WD has a slightly better reputation in the market and arguably better drives, so they charge a premium. I recommend WD's 500 GB Passport available for around Rs. 6,500. **D**

FOLLOW US ON

 **DigitIndia**

<http://twitter.com/digitindia>

 **Digit**

<http://facebook.com/digitindia>

 **Digit Club**

<http://alturl.com/rznc>

 **SMS Join DigitIndia**

to **567678**